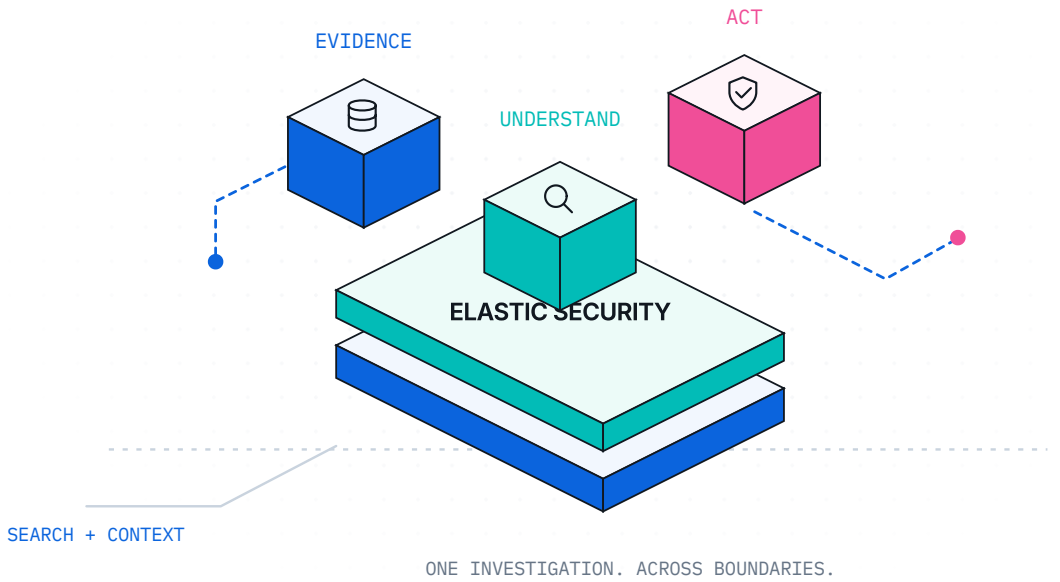
Elastic Security. Coordinated defense.

An attacker crosses boundaries. Your investigation should too. Connect the evidence, understand the attack, and act with control.



SEE

The whole attack

Connect identity, endpoint, network, and application evidence.

UNDERSTAND

What matters

Make a testable attack hypothesis, then inspect the underlying events.

ACT

With control

Authorize the response and verify the result.

Synthetic incident and illustrative UI. Capability availability depends on deployment, subscription, version, and configuration. Sources checked October 13, 2026.

SOURCES Elastic Security ↗

elastic

One incident. Three decisions.

Can we see the chain, verify its meaning, and contain it without losing authority over our systems?

1

Connect the evidence

All relevant signals

2

Verify the narrative

Source-linked reasoning

3

Control the response

Human decision points

One fictional incident. End to end.

SCOPE

Connect the evidence

Follow svc-backup from directory authentication to Windows and Linux activity.

CONFIDENCE

Separate facts from hypotheses

Treat the outbound connection as suspected transfer until evidence establishes impact.

AUTHORITY

Approve before response

Make host isolation and the account action explicit, reviewable decisions.

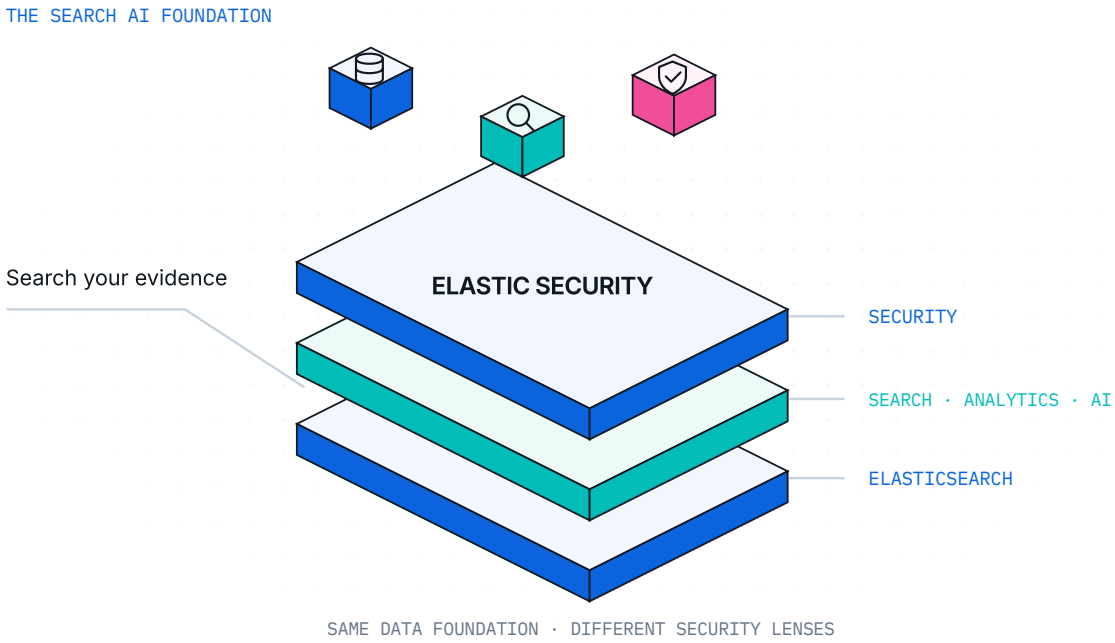
Illustrative sequence; it is not a product benchmark or a claim about response time.

SOURCES Respond and contain ↗

elastic

Security starts with searchable evidence.

Elasticsearch makes operational evidence retrievable. Security adds the detection, investigation, and response context that turns retrieval into a decision.



FOUNDATION

Search and analytics

Use shared indexed evidence to explore activity across different systems.

SECURITY

Purpose-built workflows

Apply rules, entity context, forensic views, and case management.

AI

Context before conclusions

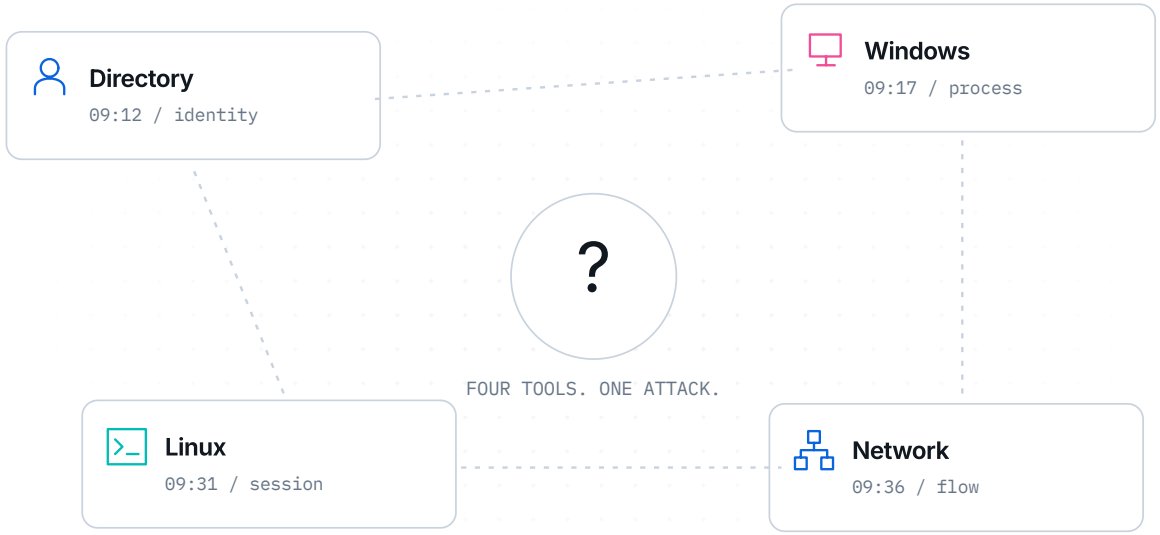
Retrieve relevant evidence before asking a model to interpret it.

The shared foundation does not imply identical features or entitlements across deployment types.

SOURCES Elastic Security ↗ Elastic Agent Builder ↗

The signals exist. The story is missing.

A valid login, a suspicious process, and an outbound connection can look unrelated when each lives in a different queue.



IDENTITY

Credentials look legitimate

The directory knows who authenticated; it does not explain the later process chain.

ENDPOINT

A process looks suspicious

The Windows event becomes more useful when connected to identity and destination activity.

NETWORK

A connection needs context

Timing and host context decide whether an outbound session warrants investigation.

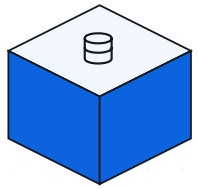
Synthetic example. Correlation depends on collected data and reliable identity, host, and time fields.

SOURCES Elastic Common Schema ↗

elastic

See. Understand. Act with control.

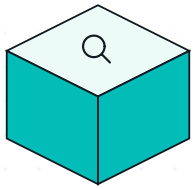
Connect the evidence, test the hypothesis, and execute an authorized response. Each step should strengthen the next.



SEE

the whole attack

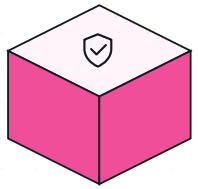
Breadth + history



UNDERSTAND

what matters

Context + reasoning



ACT

with control

Approval + evidence

A CONNECTED OPERATING MODEL

SEE

The whole attack

Broaden visibility and connect the sequence across sources.

UNDERSTAND

What matters

Prioritize with context, then verify against the evidence.

ACT

With control

Use explicit permissions, ownership, and recorded outcomes.

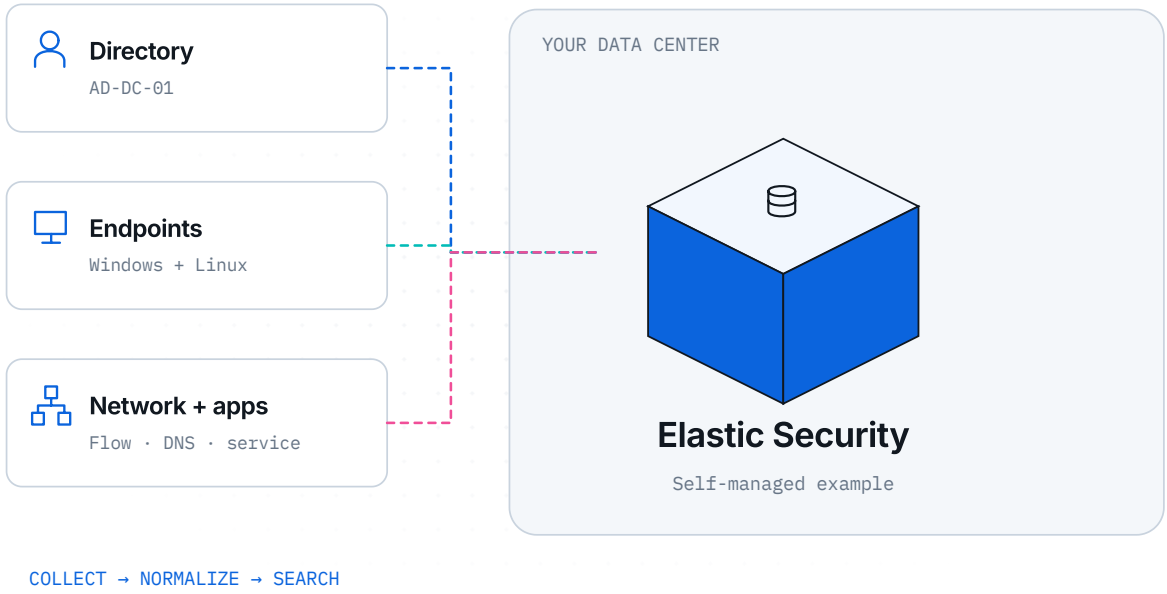
Editorial framework, not official product or subscription names.

SOURCES Elastic Security ↗

elastic

Your environment.
One evidence fabric.

Collect the identity, host, network, and application signals that explain how an attacker moves through your estate.



COLLECT

Use suitable integrations

Elastic Agent, Beats, Logstash, and third-party collectors can supply security evidence.

PRESERVE

Keep source meaning

Retain the fields needed to explain authentication, execution, and communication.

PRIORITIZE

Start with the attack path

Bring directory, Windows, Linux, and network evidence into the first evaluation.

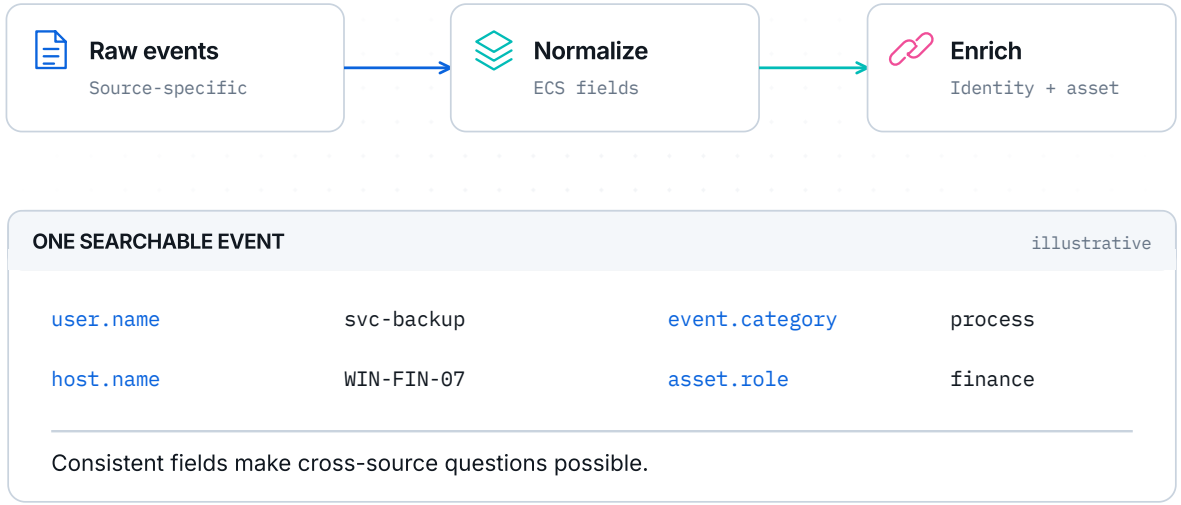
Integration support and field coverage vary. Custom collectors need ECS mappings and configured Security index patterns.

SOURCES Security data ingestion ↗

elastic

Different sources. Shared meaning.

Elastic Common Schema gives identity, host, process, and network fields a consistent shape, so evidence can be searched together.



NORMALIZE

Use consistent field names

Map source-specific identities and timestamps into dependable ECS fields.

ENRICH

Add relevant context

Include asset importance or threat intelligence where it helps a decision.

VALIDATE

Check joins and time

A shared field name still needs accurate values, parsing, and clock discipline.

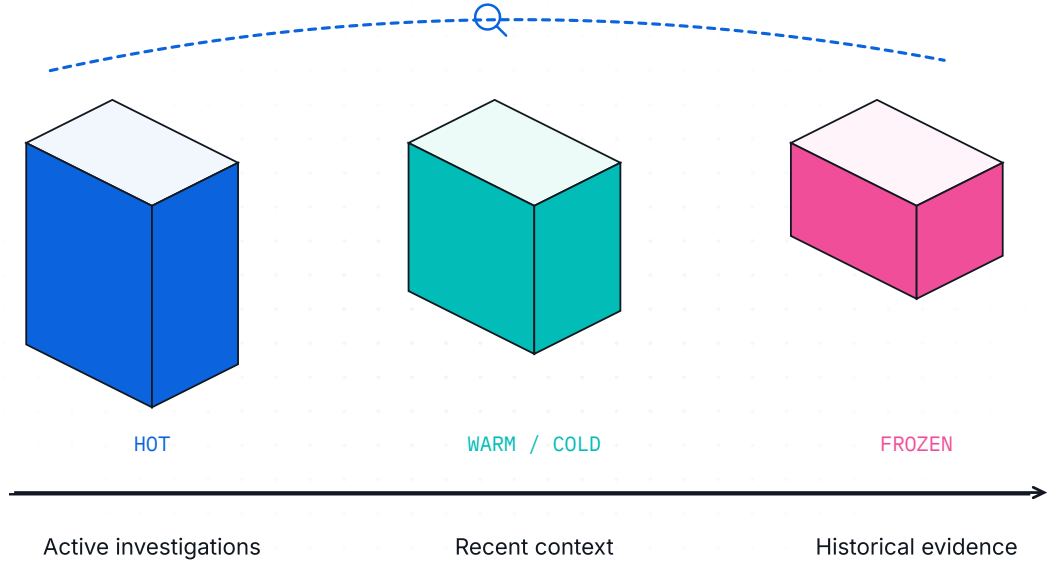
Custom mappings and enrichments require configuration. ECS does not guarantee complete or accurate source data.

SOURCES Elastic Common Schema ↗ Security data ingestion ↗

elastic

New intelligence. Existing evidence.

When the investigation changes, search earlier evidence for the first appearance, related hosts, and behavior that the original alert did not explain.



RETENTION BY VALUE. SEARCH ACROSS TIERS.

LOOK BACK

Find the first appearance

Ask whether svc-backup used the same workstation or destination before this incident.

REVISIT

Test a new hypothesis

Search retained evidence using newly identified fields or indicators.

RETAIN

Match history to purpose

Choose lifecycle tiers and retention around investigation and access requirements.

Searchable snapshots require Enterprise. Historical answers depend on retained telemetry and tier access; this is not an unlimited retention promise.

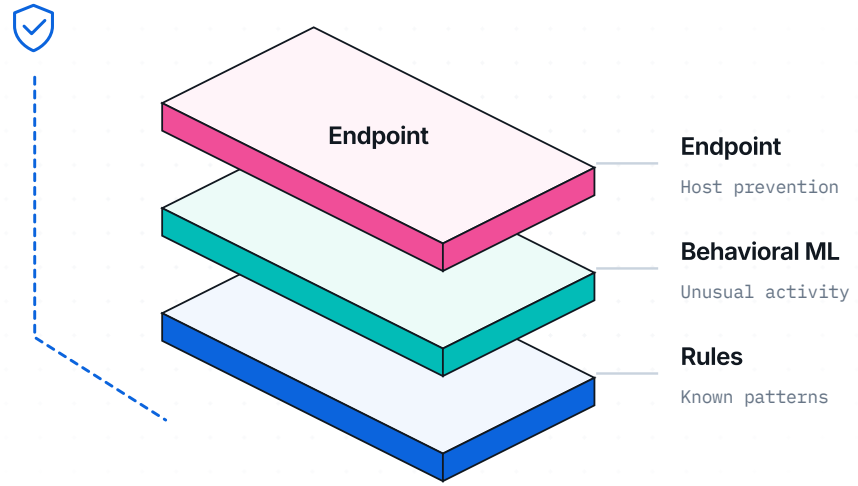
SOURCES Searchable snapshots ↗

elastic

One attack. Multiple ways to see it.

Combine known patterns, behavioral deviations, sequence correlation, and endpoint protection. Each method catches a different kind of signal.

COMPLEMENTARY METHODS



Coverage improves when methods work together.

KNOWN BEHAVIOR

Rules explain the match

Use query, threshold, indicator, and new-terms logic for explicit conditions.

DEVIATION

ML adds another lens

Surface unusual behavior that is hard to express as a fixed query.

SEQUENCE

Connect activity over time

Use event correlation where a shared entity and ordered activity matter.

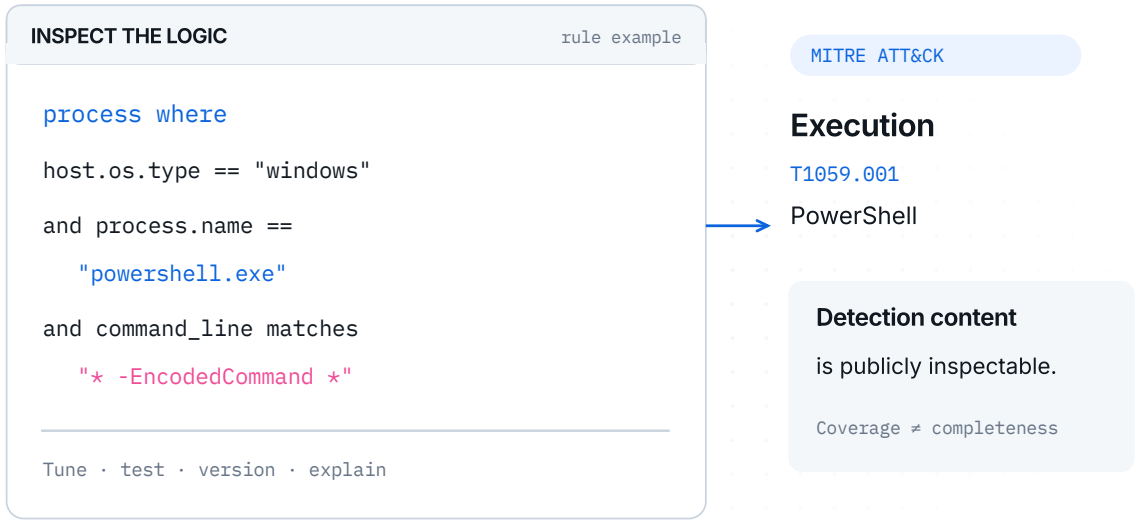
Rule prerequisites, data requirements, and subscriptions differ. Enable and tune methods against your collected data.

SOURCES Choose a detection rule type ↗ Elastic endpoint security ↗

elastic

Inspect the logic. Own the decision.

Public detection content lets your team review conditions, required telemetry, ATT&CK mappings, and investigation guidance before deploying a rule.



SYNTHETIC LOGIC EXCERPT · NOT A DEPLOYABLE RULE

INSPECT

Read the detection logic

Understand why a behavior matches and what evidence the rule requires.

TUNE

Account for your environment

Test expected administration, create justified exceptions, and measure missed detections.

OPERATE

Track coverage and changes

Review rule revisions and ATT&CK context alongside actual data coverage.

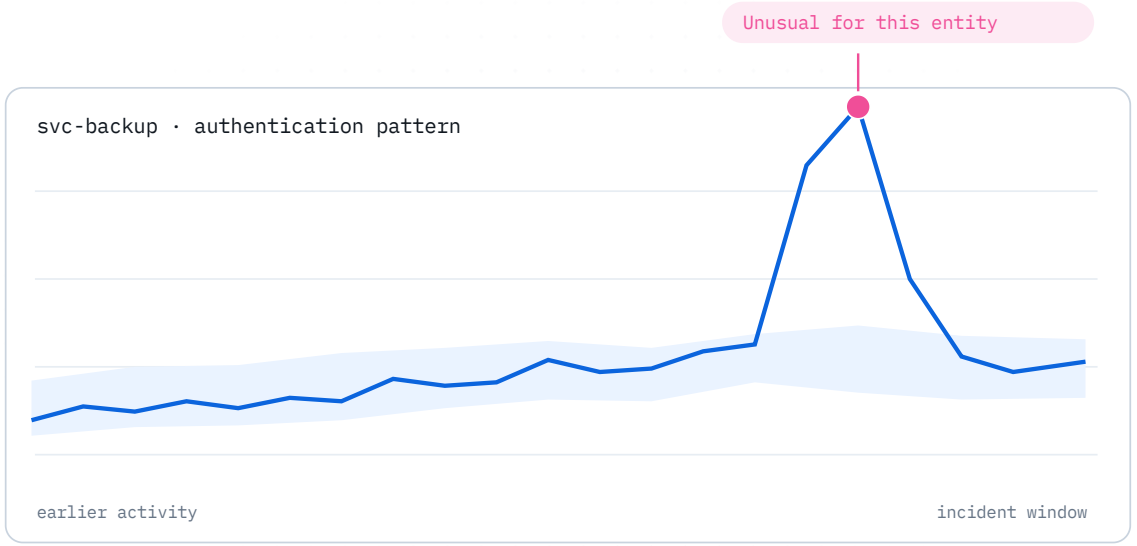
Public detection repository content is licensed under Elastic License v2. The illustrative rule shown here is teaching content, not a shipped rule.

SOURCES Public detection rules · ELv2 ↗ Detection rule concepts ↗

elastic

Known rules.
Unfamiliar behavior.

Behavioral anomaly detection adds context when a service account behaves differently from its observed patterns.



A DEVIATION IS A LEAD. VERIFY ITS CONTEXT.

BASELINE

Model observed behavior

Use suitable anomaly jobs and consistent source data to establish context.

SURFACE

Investigate a deviation

A rare access pattern can bring svc-backup into focus.

VERIFY

Anomaly is not guilt

Check maintenance, role changes, and other legitimate explanations before escalating.

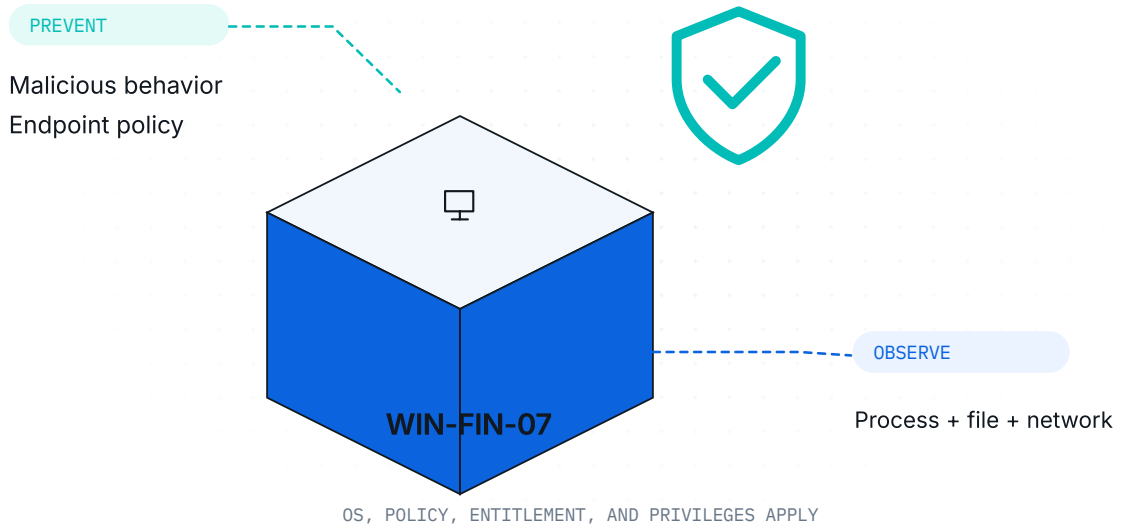
ML rules require configured anomaly jobs, suitable data, and the appropriate entitlement. A model score is not a probability of compromise.

SOURCES Machine learning rules ↗

elastic

Protect the host.
Keep the context.

Native endpoint protection combines prevention, telemetry, investigation, and supported response actions within Elastic Security.



PREVENT

Apply endpoint protection

Use supported protections and policy settings to stop malicious behaviors.

OBSERVE

Capture execution context

Process, file, and network events help explain activity on the affected host.

RESPOND

Act on supported endpoints

Isolation and other response actions require privileges, platform support, and suitable entitlement.

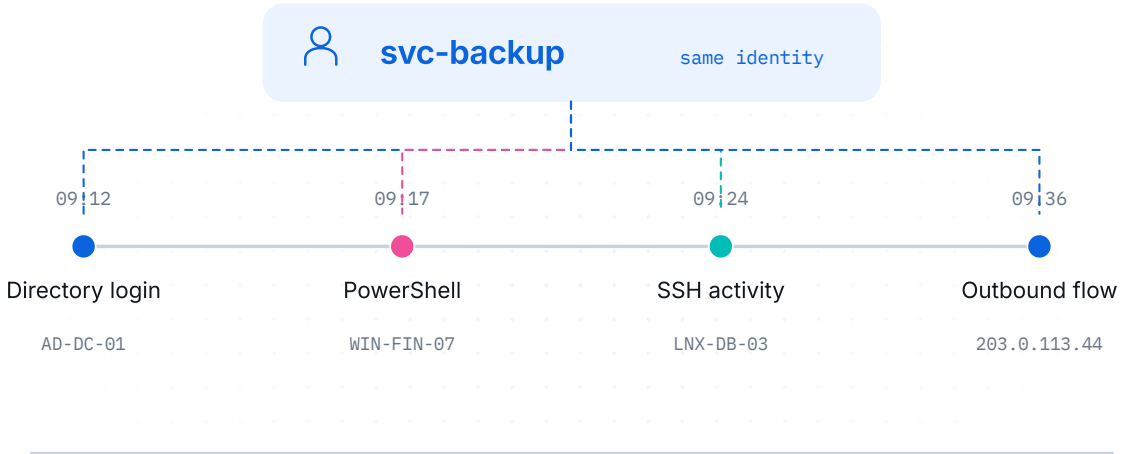
OS, policy, version, and subscription determine capabilities. No per-endpoint fee does not eliminate telemetry, infrastructure, or retention costs.

SOURCES Elastic endpoint security ↗ Security data ingestion ↗

elastic

Connect the events. Expose the sequence.

Identity, execution, and network observations become more informative when connected by account, host, and time.



Relationships expose what isolated alerts cannot.

IDENTITY

Start with svc-backup

Link observed account use across the directory and endpoint evidence.

SEQUENCE

Follow the shared fields

Connect the Windows process to the later Linux access.

EVIDENCE

Keep the source events

Preserve the individual observations that support or challenge the relationship.

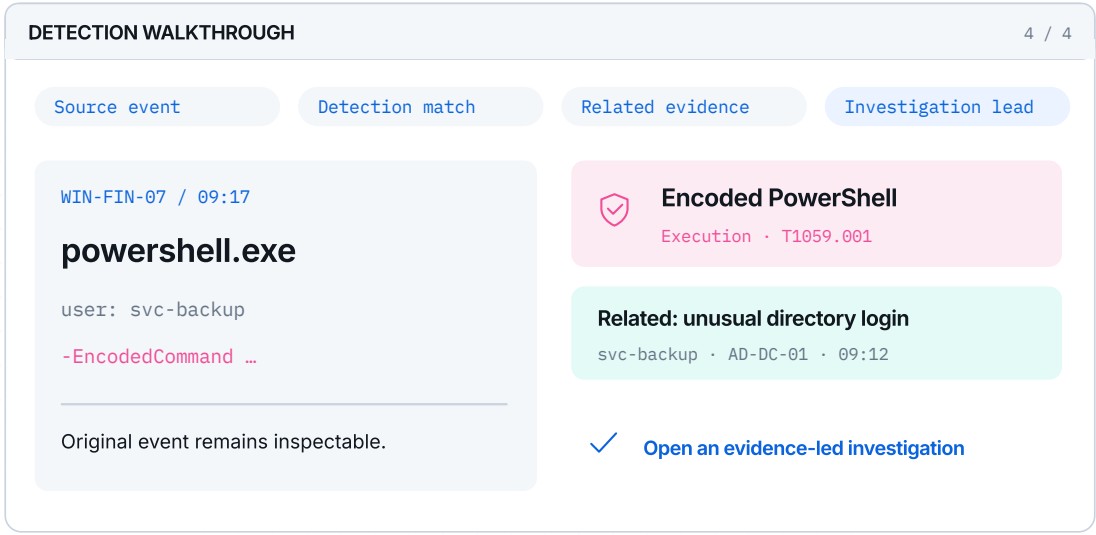
Synthetic chain. Correlation is configured detection or analyst logic, not proof of causality.

SOURCES Choose a detection rule type ↗ Timeline ↗

elastic

From a login to an attack hypothesis.

Step through the same synthetic incident. Each observation adds context; the analyst decides what the evidence establishes.



ILLUSTRATIVE EVENTS + RESULT · USER-CONTROLLED BUILD

Investigation ready 5/5

OBSERVE

Follow the sequence

Directory, Windows, Linux, and network evidence tell different parts of the story.

CORRELATE

Test the relationships

Use account, host, source address, and timestamps to connect relevant events.

QUALIFY

Keep uncertainty visible

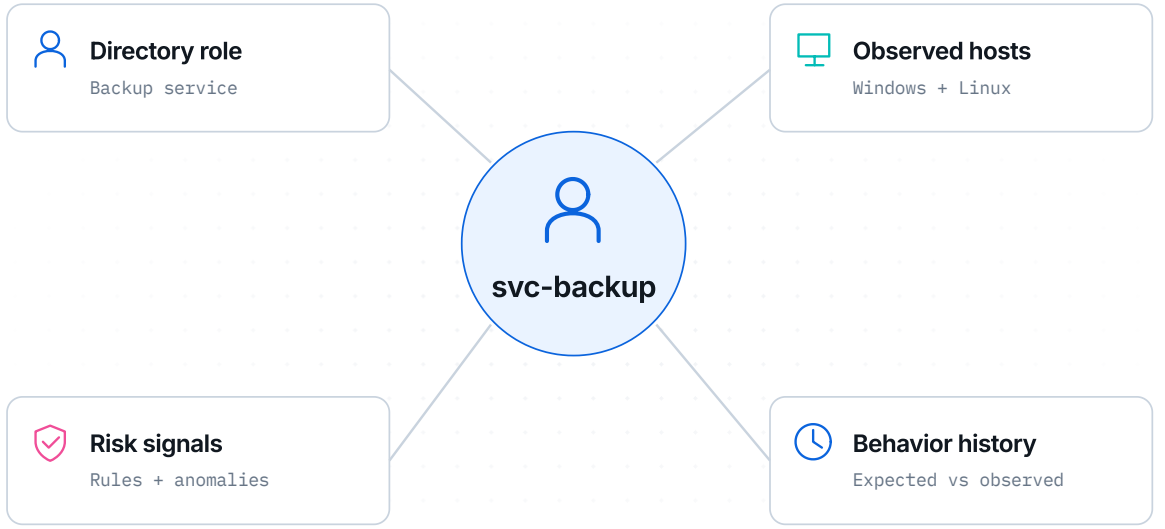
Archive creation and an outbound session raise concern; they do not establish successful theft.

Illustrative UI and data. The evidence supports suspected compromise and suspected transfer, with impact still to be verified.

SOURCES Detection rule concepts ↗ Respond and contain ↗

An alert has severity. An entity has history.

Host and account risk, asset importance, and related observations help the analyst choose where to focus.



IDENTITY + ASSET CONTEXT HELP PRIORITIZE

WHO

Review the account context

Understand the expected role and observed risk of svc-backup.

WHERE

Consider asset importance

LNX-DB-03 matters because of its business role, not only its latest alert.

WHY NOW

Inspect contributing signals

Review the evidence behind prioritization instead of treating a risk label as a verdict.

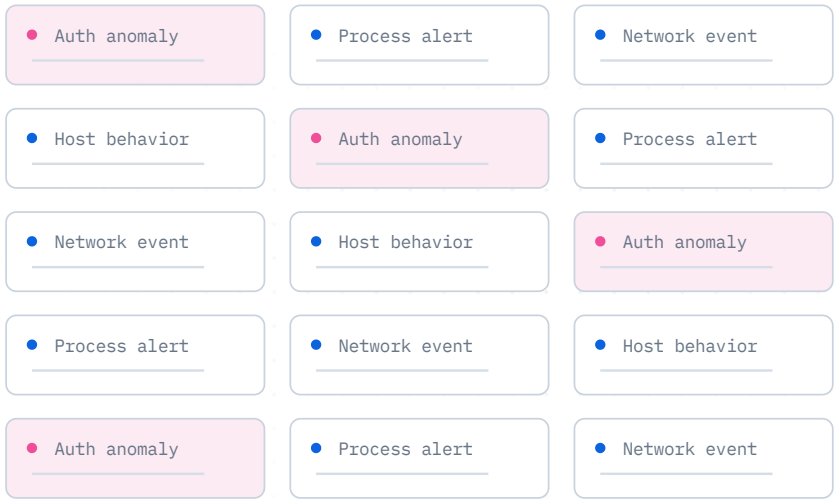
Requires the appropriate feature entitlement, entity coverage, and configuration. Risk is a prioritization aid, not a probability of compromise.

SOURCES Entity risk scoring ↗

elastic

More alerts are not more understanding.

The queue describes individual detections. The analyst needs to decide whether they form one incident, unrelated activity, or a false positive.



ALERT VOLUME IS NOT THE SAME AS UNDERSTANDING

GROUP

Find related work

Account, host, time, and detection context help avoid investigating the same chain repeatedly.

PRIORITIZE

Choose the next question

Focus on the likely scope and business impact, not only the latest row.

VERIFY

Keep the evidence accessible

A summary should lead back to the observations it describes.

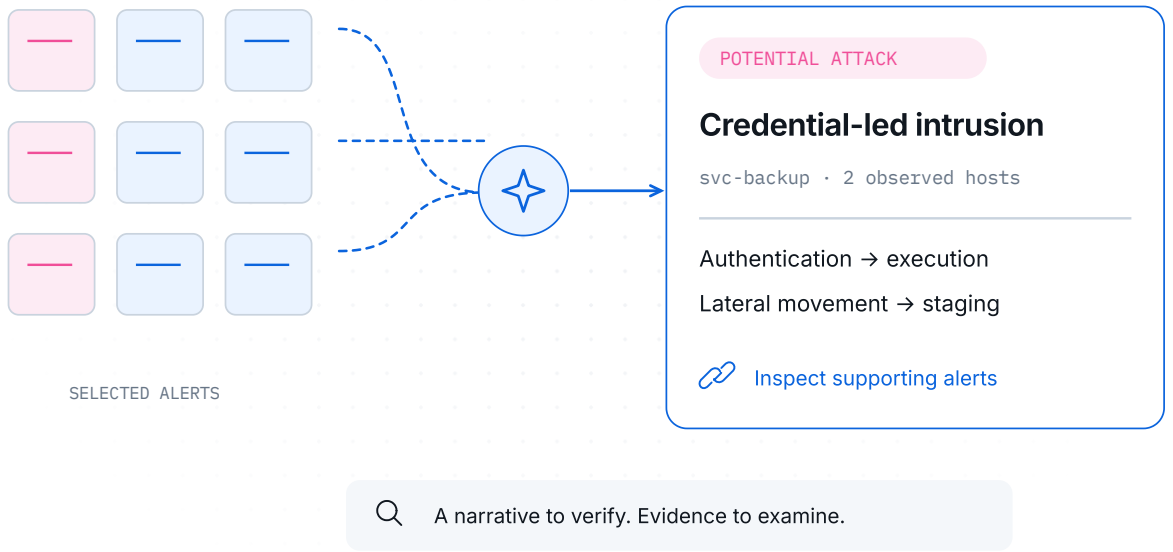
Illustrative alert counts are not a product benchmark. Alert quality depends on rule tuning, telemetry, and collection health.

SOURCES Manage detection alerts ↗

elastic

Related alerts. A potential attack.

Attack Discovery uses an LLM to find relationships among selected alerts and present an attack narrative for analyst review.



SCOPE

Analyze selected alerts

The filters and time range determine the alert evidence submitted for analysis.

EXPLAIN

Connect entities and activity

A discovery describes a potential attack and its supporting alert relationships.

REVIEW

Verify before escalation

The analyst inspects source evidence and checks alternative explanations.

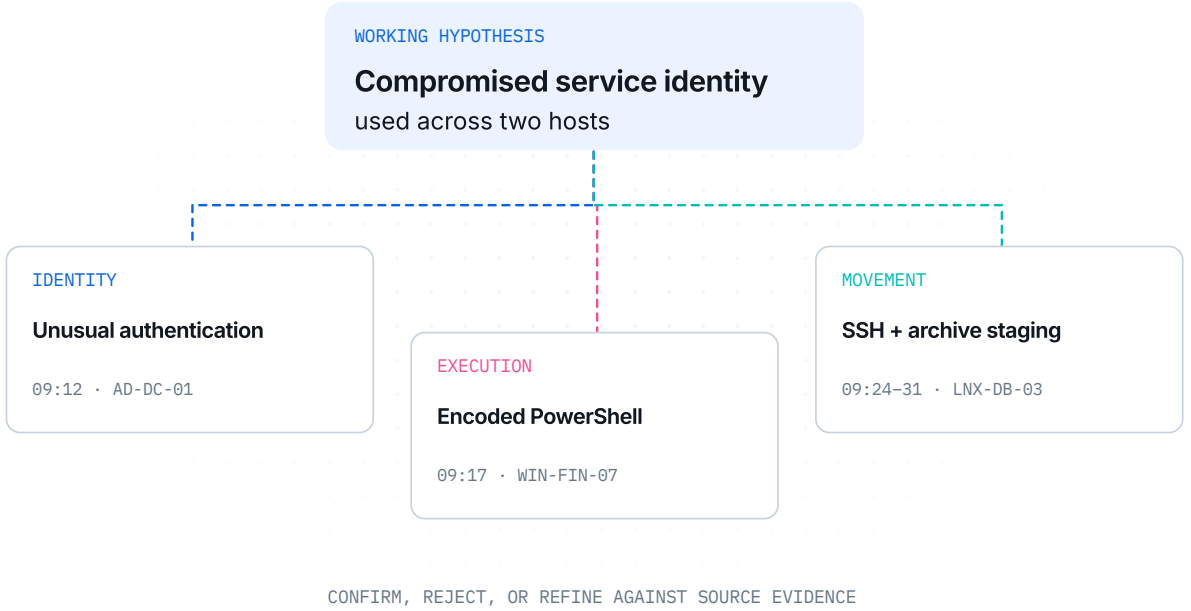
Self-managed example requires Enterprise, appropriate privileges, and a suitable configured LLM. Model limits, alert selection, and connectivity affect results.

SOURCES Attack Discovery ↗

elastic

A useful hypothesis can be challenged.

Review what supports the narrative, what contradicts it, and what evidence is still missing before declaring scope or impact.



OBSERVED

Execution and movement

Authentication and process events support unauthorized cross-host activity.

UNVERIFIED

Successful data transfer

The outbound connection follows archive creation; the example does not establish transferred contents.

NEXT QUESTION

Ask the account owner

Check the change record and expected service behavior before authorizing containment.

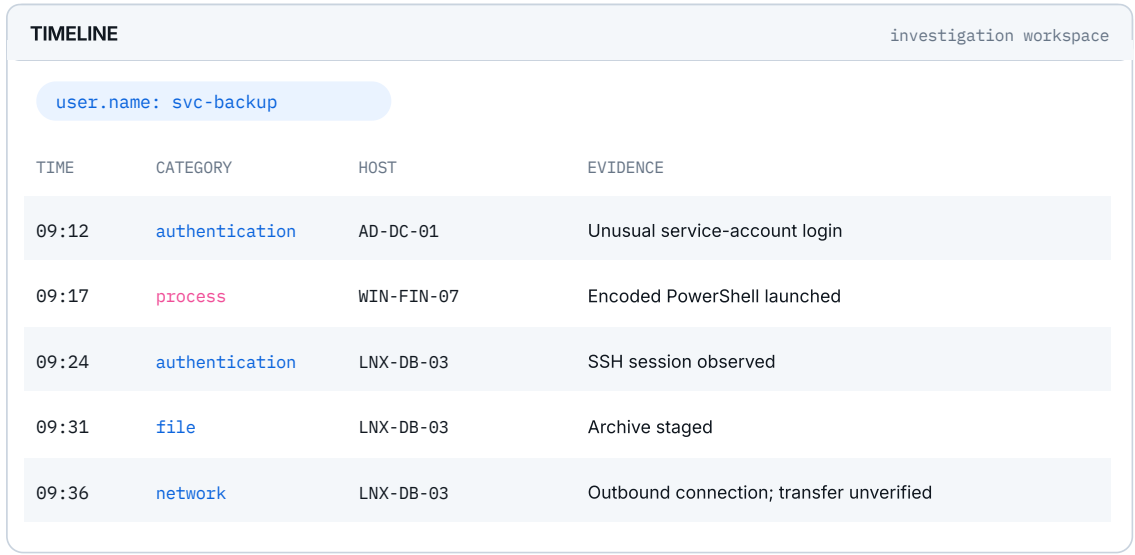
Synthetic analyst findings. AI narratives and suggested attribution require human verification; do not treat them as established facts.

SOURCES Triage discovery findings ↗

elastic

Build the chronology. Keep the evidence.

Timeline brings relevant alerts and raw events into an investigation workspace so the team can reconstruct the sequence.



FILTER · COMPARE · ANNOTATE · PRESERVE

COLLECT

Bring events together

Search relevant sources for svc-backup and the involved hosts.

RECONSTRUCT

Order the observations

Distinguish authentication, execution, movement, and the later outbound session.

SHARE

Save the investigation

Preserve the query, important events, and notes for the next analyst.

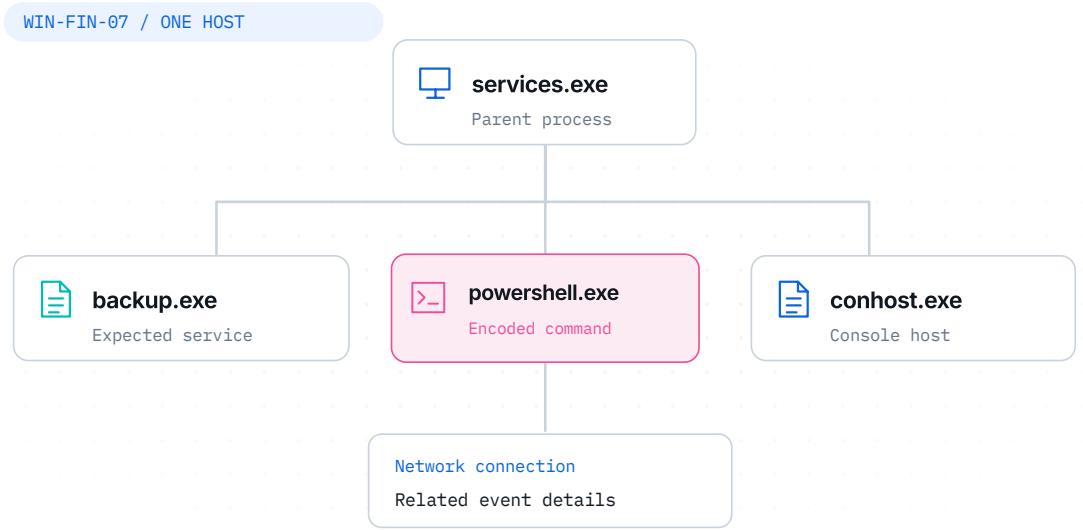
Illustrative workspace. Index access, mappings, available telemetry, and Timeline privileges determine what appears.

SOURCES Timeline ↗

elastic

Follow the process. Find the cause.

The Analyzer shows process relationships around an event, helping the analyst understand what launched it and what followed.



ANALYZER SHOWS PROCESS RELATIONSHIPS WITHIN A HOST

PARENTAGE

Trace the execution chain

Inspect parent and child processes on WIN-FIN-07.

CONTEXT

Open associated events

Review relevant process details and related file, network, or alert observations.

SCOPE

Pivot beyond this host

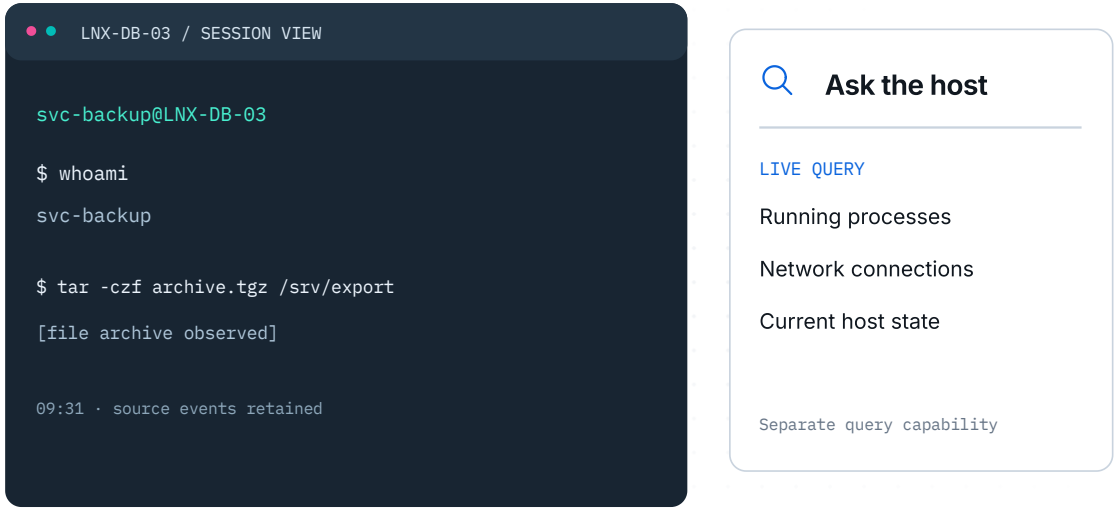
Use Timeline and other evidence to follow movement to LNX-DB-03.

Illustrative Analyzer. Supported integrations and compatible process fields are required; unavailable telemetry cannot be reconstructed.

SOURCES Visual event analyzer ↗

Reconstruct the session. Check the live host.

Session View explains Linux execution history. Osquery can inspect current host state to test what still exists or is running.



HISTORICAL SESSION CONTEXT + AUTHORIZED LIVE QUESTIONS

HISTORY

Review the Linux session

Examine the process sequence and identity context on LNX-DB-03.

LIVE STATE

Ask a precise host question

Use an authorized Osquery query to inspect relevant processes, files, or connections.

TIME

Keep the views distinct

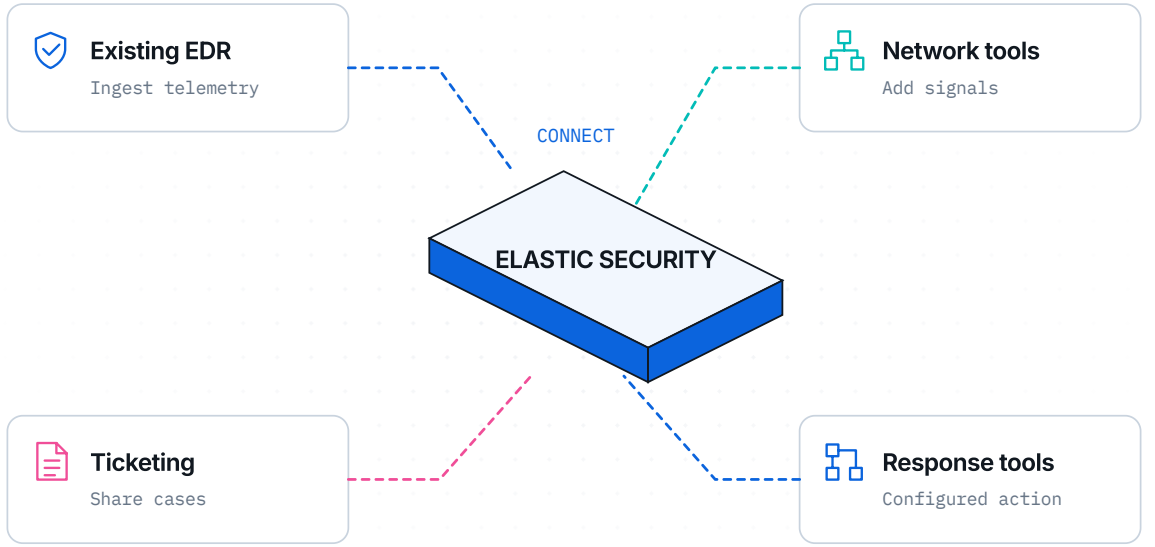
A live result describes current state; it does not replace historical evidence.

Session View needs Linux Elastic Defend session collection. Terminal output has kernel requirements. Osquery needs its integration, privileges, and reachable agents.

SOURCES Session View ↗ Osquery investigation ↗

Keep useful tools. Connect their evidence.

Bring third-party telemetry into the investigation and use configured integrations where they fit your existing operating model.



INTEGRATIONS NEED CONFIGURATION, ACCESS, AND VALIDATION

TELEMETRY

Ingest third-party signals

Normalize supported endpoint, identity, network, and security-tool evidence.

OPERATIONS

Respect existing ownership

Route cases and response requests through the team's approved processes.

EVALUATION

Prove value incrementally

Start with a meaningful data set and an attack path before expanding.

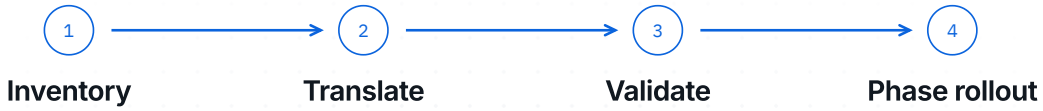
Collection and response support differ by integration. Third-party licenses, API access, connectors, and privileges may be required.

SOURCES Security data ingestion ↗ Respond and contain ↗

elastic

Translate the content. Validate the behavior.

Use assisted migration for supported SIEM assets, then test telemetry, detection semantics, and operational outcomes before retiring existing coverage.



STEP 4 / PHASE ROLLOUT

Run in parallel. Cut over with evidence.

Ownership · rollback · operating metrics

✓ Acceptance criteria govern progress.

AI ASSISTANCE ACCELERATES WORK; VALIDATION DETERMINES READINESS

TRANSLATE

Inspect the proposed result

Review supported rule and dashboard translations and unresolved dependencies.

VALIDATE

Replay meaningful scenarios

Compare expected detections, missed cases, timing, and false positives.

TRANSITION

Move in measured stages

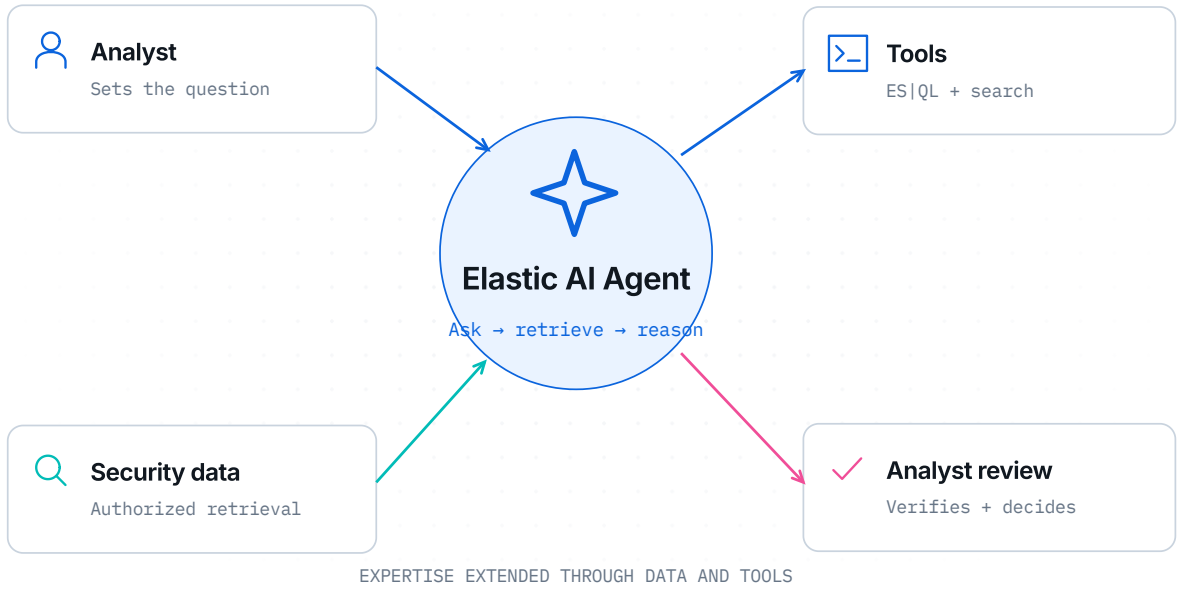
Maintain existing coverage until the replacement behavior is demonstrated.

Automatic Migration requires Enterprise on Stack, ML enabled, privileges, and a working LLM. Supported source and asset coverage has limitations.

SOURCES Automatic migration ↗

Elastic AI Agent. Grounded in evidence.

Elastic AI Agent uses Agent Builder tools to retrieve context, query Elasticsearch data, and help the analyst explore the next question.



ASK

State the investigation question

Identify the account, time window, and uncertainty you need to resolve.

RETRIEVE

Use tools against your data

Inspect relevant data and query results rather than accepting unsupported prose.

REVIEW

Keep analyst responsibility

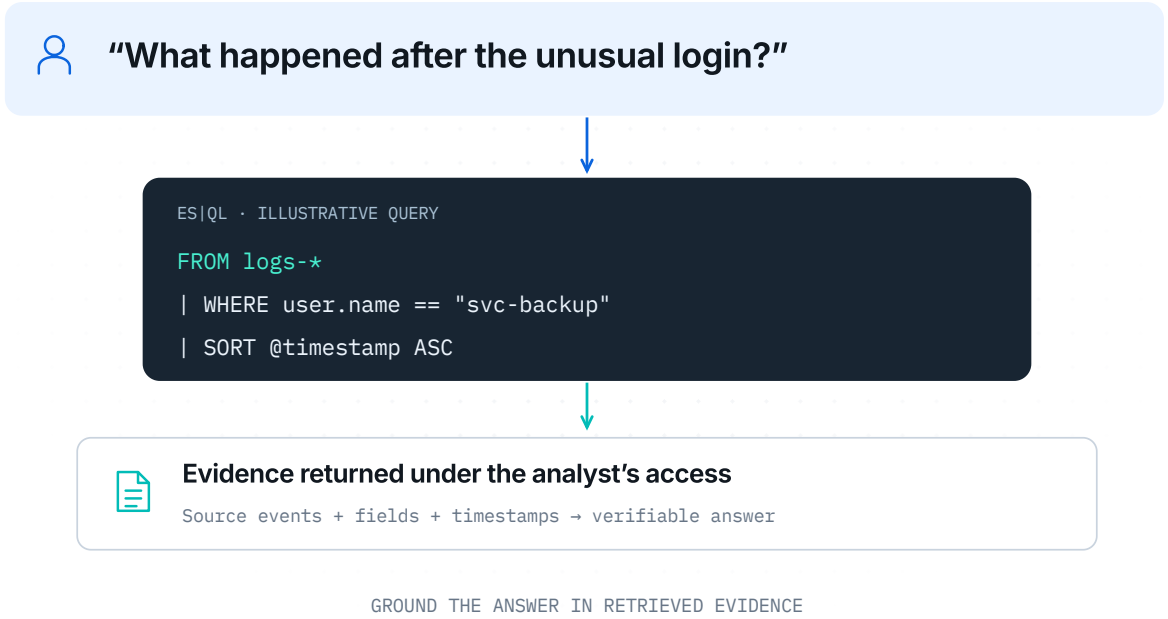
Validate the output and authorize any operational action separately.

Self-managed example requires Enterprise, supported Stack version, privileges, and a configured model. Agent Builder and AI Assistant have different controls.

SOURCES Elastic AI Agent ↗ AI Agent and Assistant differences ↗

A question becomes an inspectable query.

Use retrieval tools and ES|QL to locate relevant events, inspect the query and results, and refine the investigation.



SCOPE

Select data and time

Name the account, relevant indices, and investigation window.

RETRIEVE

Inspect the query and rows

Tool results expose the observations available to support the answer.

REFINE

Ask what is still missing

A narrow result set may need a different source, time range, or field mapping.

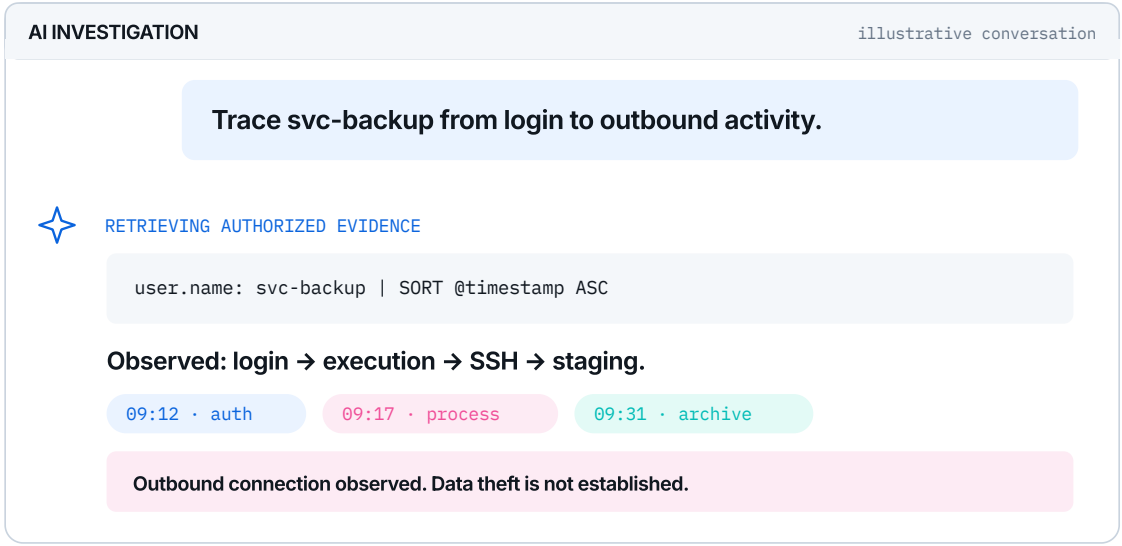
Illustrative query and result set. Tools, index privileges, mappings, model behavior, and version determine available retrieval.

SOURCES Agent Builder tools ↗ Custom ES|QL tools ↗

elastic

Ask. Retrieve. Verify. Then decide.

The conversation follows an evidence loop: a scoped question, an inspectable query, source results, and a qualified answer.



4 / VERIFY LIMITATIONS

Human verification 5/5

QUESTION

What did svc-backup do?

Scope the search to the involved hosts and the synthetic incident window.

EVIDENCE

Review the retrieved events

Compare authentication, process, file, and network observations.

CONCLUSION

State what remains unknown

Unauthorized activity is verified; successful transfer still needs evidence.

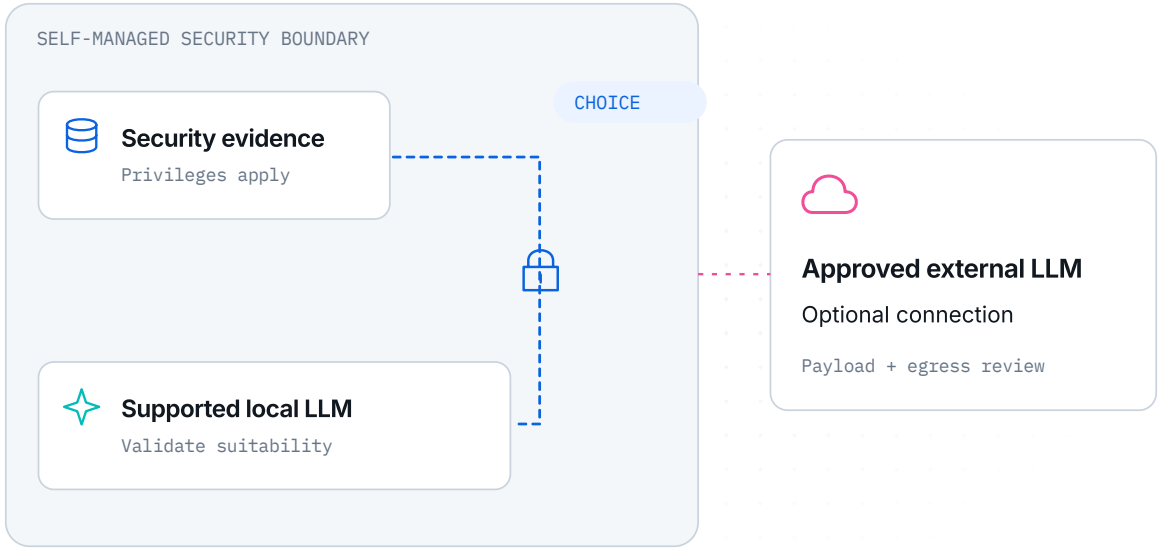
Illustrative AI Agent UI. These are not real tool calls or measured model results. Source evidence and human review remain necessary.

SOURCES Agent Builder tools ↗ Elastic AI Agent ↗

elastic

Choose the model. Verify the boundary.

Self-managed Elasticsearch can work with a supported local model or an approved external provider. Review the actual data path for each AI feature.



FEATURE-SPECIFIC MODEL, LICENSE, AND CONNECTIVITY REQUIREMENTS

MODEL

Match capability to the task

Choose dependable reasoning and tool calling, then test against security questions.

DATA PATH

Inspect what is transmitted

Review model endpoints, feature settings, fields, and provider policies.

CONTROLS

Check the chosen experience

Agent Builder and AI Assistant differ in privacy, knowledge, and audit capabilities.

Enterprise on self-managed; feature-specific model and network requirements apply. Do not assume AI Assistant anonymization or audit controls transfer to Agent Builder.

SOURCES Model configuration ↗ AI Agent and Assistant differences ↗

Turn the finding into a repeatable process.

Elastic Workflows connects defined triggers, evidence retrieval, case updates, and configured actions into a versionable operational sequence.



DESIGN THE WORKFLOW AROUND YOUR RESPONSE POLICY

DEFINE

Make the runbook explicit

Specify inputs, evidence checks, actions, permissions, and expected outputs.

CONTROL

Gate consequential actions

Use an authorized manual run or a supported configured approval pattern.

VERIFY

Inspect each result

Handle failures and confirm completion before reporting the response as successful.

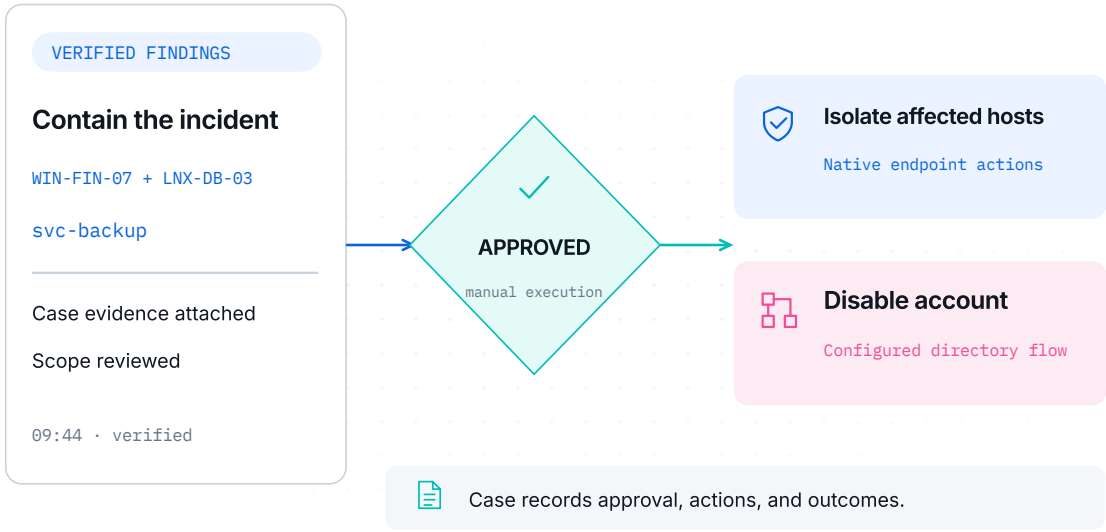
Workflows GA in Stack 9.4+ with Enterprise and privileges. Individual steps can have different status; native waitForApproval is Preview 9.5+.

SOURCES Agent Builder and Workflows ↗ Manual workflow triggers ↗ Approval step · Preview 9.5+ ↗

elastic

Decide deliberately. Confirm the result.

The analyst verifies the incident, the response owner approves containment, and the case records the action results and remaining questions.



4 / PRESERVE THE RECORD

Results confirmed 4/4

AUTHORIZE

Name the action and owner

Approve isolation of both affected hosts and the configured svc-backup directory action.

EXECUTE

Use the right action path

Endpoint isolation is native; disabling the directory account requires a configured integration.

RECORD

Verify outcomes in the case

Check success or failure and retain the unresolved impact question.

Synthetic response results. Endpoint actions need supported platforms and entitlement. GA pattern: approval before manual run; native approval step is Preview 9.5+.

SOURCES Respond and contain ↗ Manual workflow triggers ↗ Approval step · Preview 9.5+ ↗

Operate where your requirements lead.

Keep the principal example self-managed. Choose infrastructure, operational responsibility, and model connectivity to fit the environment.

PRIMARY EXAMPLE

Self-managed

Your infrastructure

Your data controls

Your operating responsibilities

Data center / private cloud

Elastic Cloud

Managed deployment option

Serverless

Managed service option

COMPARE CAPABILITIES + ENTITLEMENTS FOR EACH DEPLOYMENT

SELF-MANAGED

Your infrastructure and operations

Run the Stack on premises or private infrastructure with your chosen controls.

ORCHESTRATED

ECE or Kubernetes with ECK

Use supported orchestration where it fits your platform and operating model.

MANAGED

Hosted or Serverless options

Evaluate managed services with their deployment-specific features and pricing.

Features, subscriptions, networking, and operational responsibilities vary. EASE is a Serverless project type, not an on-premises installable capability.

SOURCES Deployment options ↗ Model configuration ↗

elastic

Design the coverage. Understand the cost.

Compute, telemetry volume, storage, retention, and investigation access patterns shape the operating cost. Measure them against the coverage you need.

THE RESOURCE EQUATION

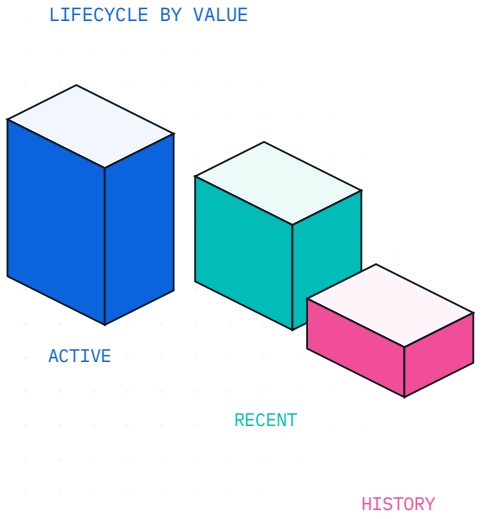
Ingest

+ Compute

+ Retention

Operating cost

Measure against your workload



Elastic Defend entitlement does not remove telemetry and storage costs.

COVERAGE

Collect evidence with purpose

Retain enough context to investigate the attack paths and assets that matter.

LIFECYCLE

Match storage to access

Use appropriate tiers and eligible searchable snapshots for older read-only evidence.

ENDPOINT

No per-endpoint license fee

Appropriate Elastic entitlement includes native protection; telemetry and infrastructure still cost resources.

No universal savings claim. Searchable snapshots require Enterprise; retrieval costs and performance vary. Endpoint feature entitlement and telemetry costs remain relevant.

SOURCES Searchable snapshots ↗ Elastic endpoint security ↗

elastic

Customer outcomes. Their evidence.

UOL and Proficio report improved security investigation outcomes. Use their results as examples, then measure your own operating baseline.

UOL

80%

faster incident resolution

Customer-reported outcome

elastic.co/customers/uol

PROFICIO

34%

less investigation time

Customer-reported outcome

elastic.co/customers/proficio

REAL CUSTOMER EXAMPLES. RESULTS VARY BY ENVIRONMENT.

UOL

80% faster incident resolution

Customer-reported result from combining Elastic security and observability capabilities.

PROFICIO

34% less investigation time

Customer attributes the reduction to AI Assistant summaries and remediation guidance.

YOUR SOC

Define your own success criteria

Compare verified scope, analyst effort, response quality, and operating cost on representative cases.

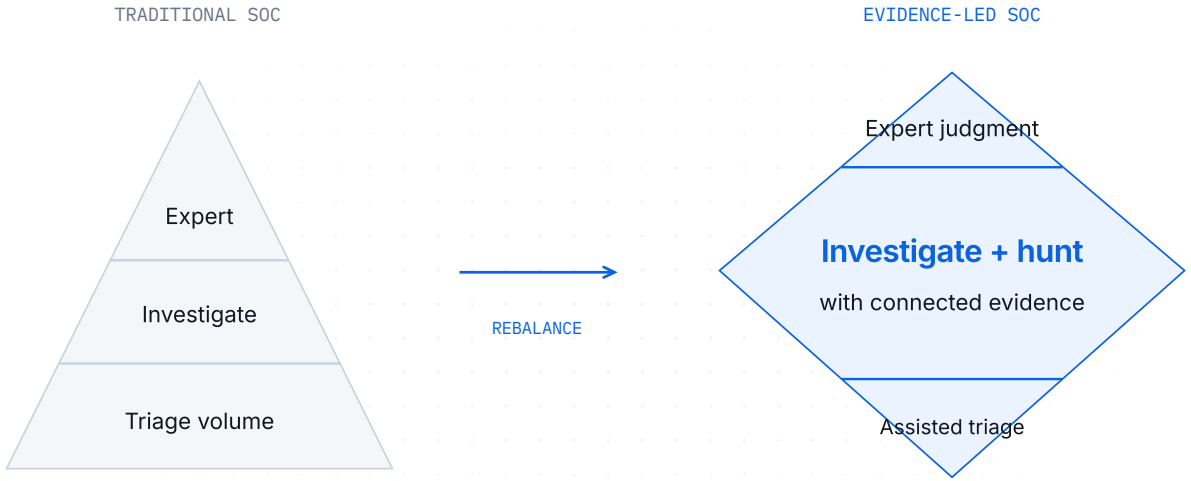
Customer-reported outcomes, not guarantees, comparative benchmarks, or a prediction for your deployment.

SOURCES UOL customer-reported results ↗ Proficio customer-reported results ↗

elastic

Contain the incident. Keep learning.

The synthetic incident moves from disconnected observations to verified unauthorized activity and approved containment, while impact review stays open.



✓ **svc-backup incident: verified, approved, contained, recorded.**

EVIDENCE

A shared investigation context

Directory, Windows, Linux, and network observations support one documented chain.

DECISION

A qualified conclusion

Unauthorized activity is verified; transfer contents and wider impact remain under review.

OPERATION

A repeatable improvement loop

Confirm response results, review collection gaps, and tune the runbook and detections.

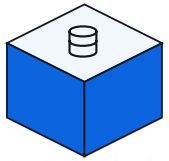
Fictional outcome and timestamps. This demonstrates a workflow, not a response-time benchmark or a closed-impact claim.

SOURCES Respond and contain ↗ Detection rule concepts ↗

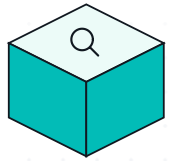
elastic

One attack path. A measurable evaluation.

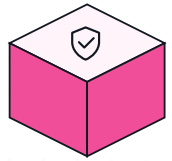
Choose a meaningful on-premises scenario, connect the evidence, and test the decisions your SOC needs to make.



See the whole attack.



Understand what matters.



Act with control.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Evaluate one use case with your evidence.

PROVE COVERAGE · MEASURE QUALITY · PRACTICE RESPONSE

SEE

Can we establish the scope?

Verify the source coverage, entity relationships, and searchable history.

UNDERSTAND

Can we explain the decision?

Inspect the hypothesis, evidence, alternative explanations, and analyst review.

ACT

Can we execute with authority?

Test an approved response and confirm its result in a non-production evaluation.

Evaluation recommendations are a proposed operating approach. Confirm feature support and policy in the selected customer environment.

SOURCES Elastic Security ↗ Deployment options ↗

elastic